

THE TRAJECTAS LEADERSHIP INDEX

A leadership capability assessment built around how leadership actually works.

Most leadership assessments measure traits. The TLI measures something more useful: where, in the actual work of leadership, does this person create progress — and where do they create risk?

READ → SHAPE → COMMIT → MOBILISE → ADVANCE

01 — THE WORK OF LEADERSHIP

Leadership has a recognisable shape.

Leadership is the work of moving from ambiguity to responsible progress. Leaders **read** the situation, **shape** the problem, **commit** to a path, **mobilise** people and systems, then **advance** through delivery and learning.

Read



Shape



Commit



Mobilise



Advance

The TLI measures how effectively a leader does each phase of that work — and identifies where their trajectory strengthens, slows, or breaks down. It is not a personality test. It is not a leadership style inventory. It tells you where leadership is working, and where it isn't.

02 — WHAT IT MEASURES

Ten capabilities across five phases.

Each phase contains an **active** capability — the work itself — and a **grounding** capability — the discipline that keeps the work honest.

PHASE	ACTIVE	GROUNDING
Read	Strategic Inquiry	Human Insight
Shape	Problem Framing	Value Focus
Commit	Decision Quality	Accountable Judgement
Mobilise	Operating Design	Relational Leadership
Advance	Delivery Discipline	Adaptive Learning

The pairing matters. Inquiry without people-orientation becomes academic. Deciding without accountability becomes recklessness. Structuring without commitment becomes compliance theatre. Strong leadership requires both sides.

03 — WHAT YOU GET

A 15-minute assessment. A practical diagnostic.

The TLI produces a profile that is read in minutes and useful in coaching, succession, and selection conversations.

- **Capability scores** — where the leader is reliable, context-dependent, or at risk.
- **Phase trajectory** — which parts of the leadership cycle hold up and which break down.
- **Imbalance flags** — where the active and grounding capabilities are out of step. Often the most diagnostically interesting finding.
- **Archetypal pattern** — which of six recognisable leadership patterns the profile most closely resembles.
- **Development focus** — specific practices the leader can build to strengthen each capability.

04 — WHY IT'S DIFFERENT

Built on how leadership works — not how leaders look.

Capability, not personality.

Every indicator is a developable practice, not a fixed trait. Coaching focuses on building specific routines, not on changing who someone is.

Process, not profile.

The trajectory diagnoses where leadership breaks — Read, Shape, Commit, Mobilise, or Advance — rather than producing a generic strengths map.

Grounded in research.

Built on over five decades of leadership and organisational psychology — Weick's sensemaking, Edmondson's psychological safety, Locke & Latham's goal-setting, Tetlock's calibrated judgement.

Designed for senior leadership.

Innovation is treated as an outcome of the trajectory, not a standalone trait. AI-augmented leadership is built into the model, not bolted on.

05 — WHAT IT'S FOR

Four primary uses.

 Leadership development and coaching Succession assessment and pipeline planning Organisational leadership capability mapping Executive search assessment — as one input among several

For high-stakes selection, the TLI is used **alongside structured interview and other inputs — never alone.**

06 — COMPANION DOCUMENTS

Three further documents are available.

Overview & Practitioner Guide

The full model walkthrough for coaches and practitioners.

Technical Manual

Model architecture, measurement approach, scoring methodology, and research grounding — for sophisticated buyers and assessment teams.

Foundational Research Grounding

Comprehensive research evidence, critiques, and validation planning — for academic review.

Read. Shape. Commit. Mobilise. **Advance.**

The leadership trajectory the TLI measures.